

Product Management Team Skills and Competency Checklist - Driving Confidence Car Cam

Cam Car Product Development Final Project | Written by Brian McCarthy

The Car Cam project requires a balanced product team because the schedule is tight, the market is crowded, supplier risk exists, and the product must satisfy safety, usability, quality, and value expectations. The checklist below identifies core skills and explains why each skill is required for a successful May 15 launch.

Product Team Skill / Competency	Needed?	Justification for Selection
Customer empathy and customer discovery	Yes	The product must support crash evidence, parked-car monitoring, road-trip recording, reckless-driving documentation, and safer driving habits. The team must understand parents of teen drivers, commuters, commercial users, and rideshare drivers well enough to design features around real customer anxiety and everyday vehicle use.
Market analysis and segmentation	Yes	The scenario identifies parents of new teenage drivers and buyers aged 35-49 as important purchasers. The team needs market analysis to prioritize target segments, understand competitor weaknesses, and focus messaging on customers most likely to buy before peak summer driving season.
Competitive analysis / Porter Five Forces	Yes	The Car Cam market is highly competitive, with pressure from substitutes, rival brands, buyer choice, and supplier risk. The team must understand these forces to decide where to differentiate, where to control costs, and how to reduce launch risks.
Product strategy and positioning	Yes	DC LLC needs to position the Car Cam as affordable, adaptable, dependable, and faster in data transfer. Strong positioning helps avoid competing only on price and makes the product's mounting flexibility and front/interior camera adaptability easier for buyers to remember.
Requirements prioritization	Yes	There are many possible features, but the launch target is May 15. The team must prioritize must-have capabilities and prevent scope creep. Crash evidence, parked-car monitoring, road-trip recording, flexible mounting, and reliable data transfer should receive priority over lower-value enhancements.
Technical solution judgment	Yes	The product depends on camera modules, processors, power, lenses, brackets, cables, and SD cards. The team must make realistic technical choices that support quality, cost, mounting flexibility, and delivery timing without creating unnecessary hardware or integration risk.
Supplier and vendor management	Yes	DC LLC has some supplier contracts, but new partnerships may be required and supply chain issues may increase costs or delay delivery. The team needs vendor management to secure parts, qualify alternates, and protect the launch schedule.
Cross-functional communication	Yes	Josie must coordinate with marketing, engineering, suppliers, leadership, and possibly customer research participants. Clear communication reduces rework, aligns teams around milestones, and keeps Ajay's marketing plan synchronized with actual product capabilities.
Decision-making under pressure	Yes	The project runs from January 15 to a planned May 15 launch, which creates schedule pressure. The product manager must avoid analysis paralysis, make informed tradeoffs, and keep the team moving without sacrificing essential quality or safety-related functionality.
Data-informed product management	Yes	The team must use reliable data to make design and launch decisions. After launch, Josie will track sales, revenue, returns, complaints, and market share, so data literacy is required both before launch and during post-launch performance management.
Public relations and launch planning	Yes	A successful launch requires a strong PR plan, clear media assets, targeted communications, and measurable goals. Marketing must explain why the Car Cam is different, why it matters for teen-driver safety, and why it is a strong value.
Quality assurance and risk management	Yes	Because many competitor products are low quality, DC LLC must validate reliability, screen quality, mounting stability, data transfer performance, storage behavior, and customer setup experience. Risk management should also cover supplier, schedule, and customer-satisfaction risks.